

CONTEXT FOR ASTRA

You are my German tutor. I am Kevin, Italian, level A2-B1. My lessons are taught in English by a native German speaker (Stefanie). Today we are reviewing: **Free Conversation and Comparatives**

Sections covered: Comparatives: nicht so...wie structure, Purpose clauses: um...zu, Reflexive verbs: sich freuen auf/über, Negation: kein vs. nicht, Separable verbs in present tense

LESSON SUMMARY

Kevin and Stefanie discussed Kevin's weekend plans to attend a car race in Monza. The conversation covered weather differences between regions, Kevin's membership benefits, and gift preferences. Grammar focused on comparative structures ('nicht so...wie'), the verb 'sich freuen' with prepositions 'auf' and 'über', and purpose clauses with 'um...zu'. Vocabulary included climate-related terms, event terminology, and expressions of satisfaction. Kevin demonstrated good intuition for B1 structures while receiving corrections on negation and preposition usage.

KEY VOCABULARY

- **die Klimaanlage** — air conditioning [A2]
- **die Ebene** — plain, flatland [B1]
- **lügen** — to lie [A2]
- **das Rennen** — race [A2]
- **rennen** — to run (fast) [A2]
- **die Mitgliedschaft** — membership [B1]
- **das Mitglied** — member [B1]
- **der Eintritt** — entrance, admission [B1]
- **der Rabatt** — discount [B1]
- **reduzieren** — to reduce [B1]
- **erhöhen** — to increase, to raise [B1]
- **sinken** — to sink, to fall, to drop [B1]
- **steigen** — to rise, to increase [B1]
- **die Veranstaltung** — event [B1]
- **die Hauptstadt** — capital city [A2]
- **das Geschenk** — present, gift [A2]
- **die Geduld** — patience [B1]
- **der Urlaub** — vacation, holiday [A2]
- **sich freuen auf** — to look forward to [B1]
- **sich freuen über** — to be pleased about [B1]
- **durchstreichen** — to cross out [B1]
- **lieber** — rather, preferably [A2]

GRAMMAR POINTS

Comparative structure: nicht so...wie

→ Used to express inequality/inferiority in comparisons, meaning 'not as...as'. The positive (base) form of the adjective is used between 'so' and 'wie'.

e.g. *Du bist nicht so intelligent wie ich. (You're not as intelligent as me.)*

e.g. *Es ist nicht so heiß wie im Sommer. (It's not as hot as in summer.)*

Purpose clauses with um...zu

→ Used to express purpose or intention ('in order to'). The structure connects a main clause with an infinitive construction. The subject must be the same in both clauses.

e.g. *Ich gehe nach Monza, um ein Autorennen zu sehen. (I'm going to Monza [in order] to see a car race.)*

e.g. *Er lernt Deutsch, um in Deutschland zu arbeiten. (He's learning German [in order] to work in Germany.)*

sich freuen auf vs. sich freuen über

→ 'Sich freuen auf' (+ accusative) expresses looking forward to future events. 'Sich freuen über' (+ accusative) expresses being pleased about present or past events.

e.g. *Ich freue mich auf das Wochenende. (I'm looking forward to the weekend - future)*

e.g. *Wir freuen uns auf den Ausflug. (We're looking forward to the excursion - future)*

Negation with kein vs. nicht

→ 'Kein' negates nouns (nominal phrases) and replaces indefinite articles or no article. 'Nicht' negates entire sentences, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, or nouns with definite articles.

e.g. *Ich habe keine Zeit. (I have no time / I don't have time - indefinite noun)*

e.g. *Es gibt keinen großen Rabatt. (There's no big discount - indefinite noun with adjective)*

Separable verb: abfahren

→ The separable verb 'abfahren' means 'to depart/leave/set off'. In main clauses with simple tenses, the prefix 'ab' separates from 'fahren' and moves to the end of the sentence.

e.g. *Der Zug fährt um 8 Uhr ab. (The train departs at 8 o'clock.)*

e.g. *Ich fahre am Morgen ab. (I'm leaving in the morning.)*

USEFUL PHRASES / REDEMittel

- **Freut mich** — Pleased to meet you (*Fixed expression used when meeting someone for the first time, short for 'Es freut mich, dich/Sie kennenzulernen'*)
- **Ich wünsche dir einen schönen Urlaub** — I wish you a nice vacation (*Common expression for wishing someone well before their holiday*)
- **in der Nähe** — close by, nearby (*Used to express physical or metaphorical proximity, as in 'Du warst in der Nähe' (You were close)*)

EXERCISES TO GENERATE

1. FILL IN THE BLANK (5 sentences)

Use the key vocabulary above. Leave one word blank per sentence. Show the answer after a separator.

2. TRANSLATION DE → EN (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

3. TRANSLATION EN → DE (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

4. DIALOGUE COMPLETION (2 short dialogues, 3-4 lines)

Leave one or two lines blank. Context: everyday situations using today's grammar (Comparative structure: nicht so...wie).

5. FREE WRITING PROMPT

Ask me to write 3-5 sentences in German using at least 5 words from today's vocabulary.

6. GRAMMAR DRILL (5 sentences)

Focus on: Comparative structure: nicht so...wie. Show sentences with errors for me to correct.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Correct all my answers immediately with explanation in English
- Note recurring mistakes throughout the session
- Use only A2-B1 vocabulary unless I ask for more
- If I write something correct but unnatural, suggest a more native alternative
- Use 'die KI' not 'AI' when referring to artificial intelligence